OSA User Training Guide

Oct 7, 2026 · @Osama Alhabaybeh

Version 2 — 12 October 2026. This version covers the new sign-in page, notifications with numbers on each tab, department visibility, staff and reports, workflow requests, and using OSA on a phone.

Welcome to OSA

OSA (Operations Service Assistance) is the one place where we report IT problems, follow them until they are fixed, and also log lost property, equipment maintenance IT access for new staff and requests that need approvals. This guide takes about 20 minutes to read.

Everyone uses sections 1 to 3 and 9. Sections marked **IT staff** or **Managers** only apply to those roles.

I want to...	Go to
Report something broken (PC, phone, Wi-Fi, POS, printer)	Tickets, then New Ticket
See what happened to my report	Tickets
Log an item a guest left behind	Lost & Found, then Report Found Item
See which equipment checks are due	Maintenance
Ask for IT access for a new employee	Access Requests, then New Request
Ask for something that needs approvals first (HR, Head of Department, Finance, IT)	Workflow Requests, then New Request
Change my password or sign out	My name (top right)

1. Signing in and finding your way

Open OSA in your web browser, type your username and password, and click **Sign In**. IT gives you these when your account is created.

1. Open the address IT gave you (for example http://192.168.1.50:3000).

2. Type your **Username** and **Password**, then click **Sign In**.
3. First time only: click your name (top right), choose **Change Password**, and set one only you know.
4. When you finish, click your name and choose **Sign Out**, especially on a shared PC.

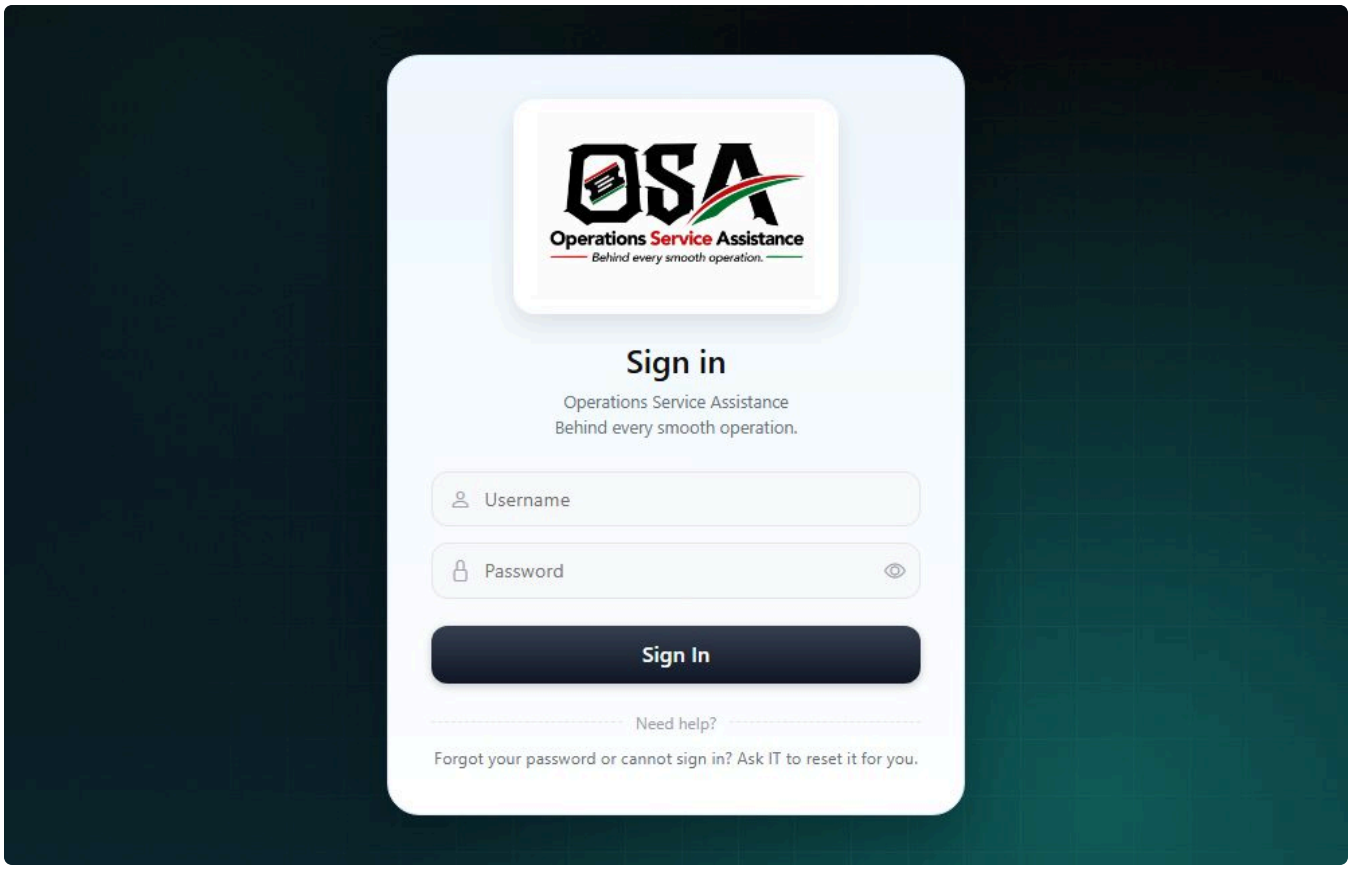


Figure 1: The sign-in page.

After signing in you land on the **Home** screen. It shows a tile for each area you can use: Tickets, Lost & Found, IT Access Request, Workflow Requests, Preventive Maintenance and, for some people, Admin or Reports. Click a tile to go there.

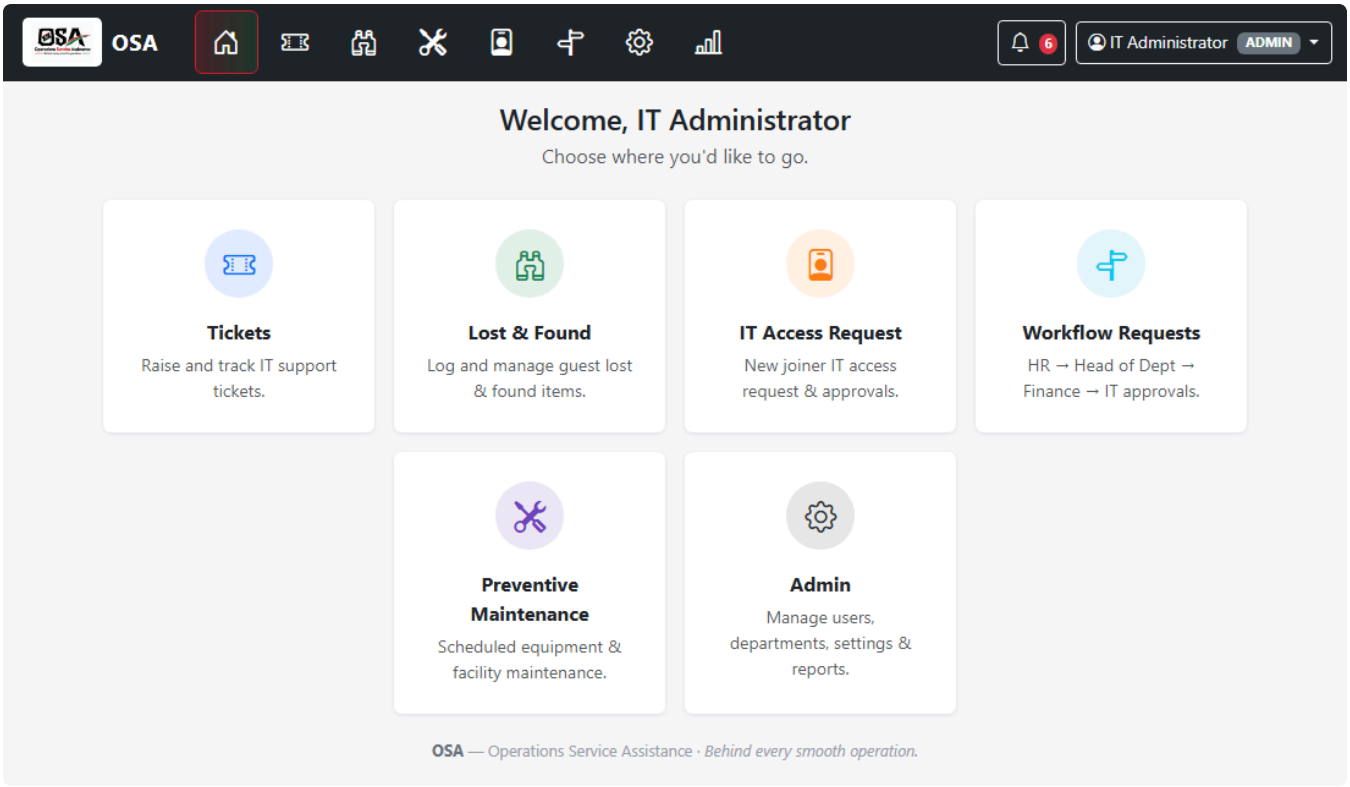


Figure 2: The Home screen. Click a tile to open that area.

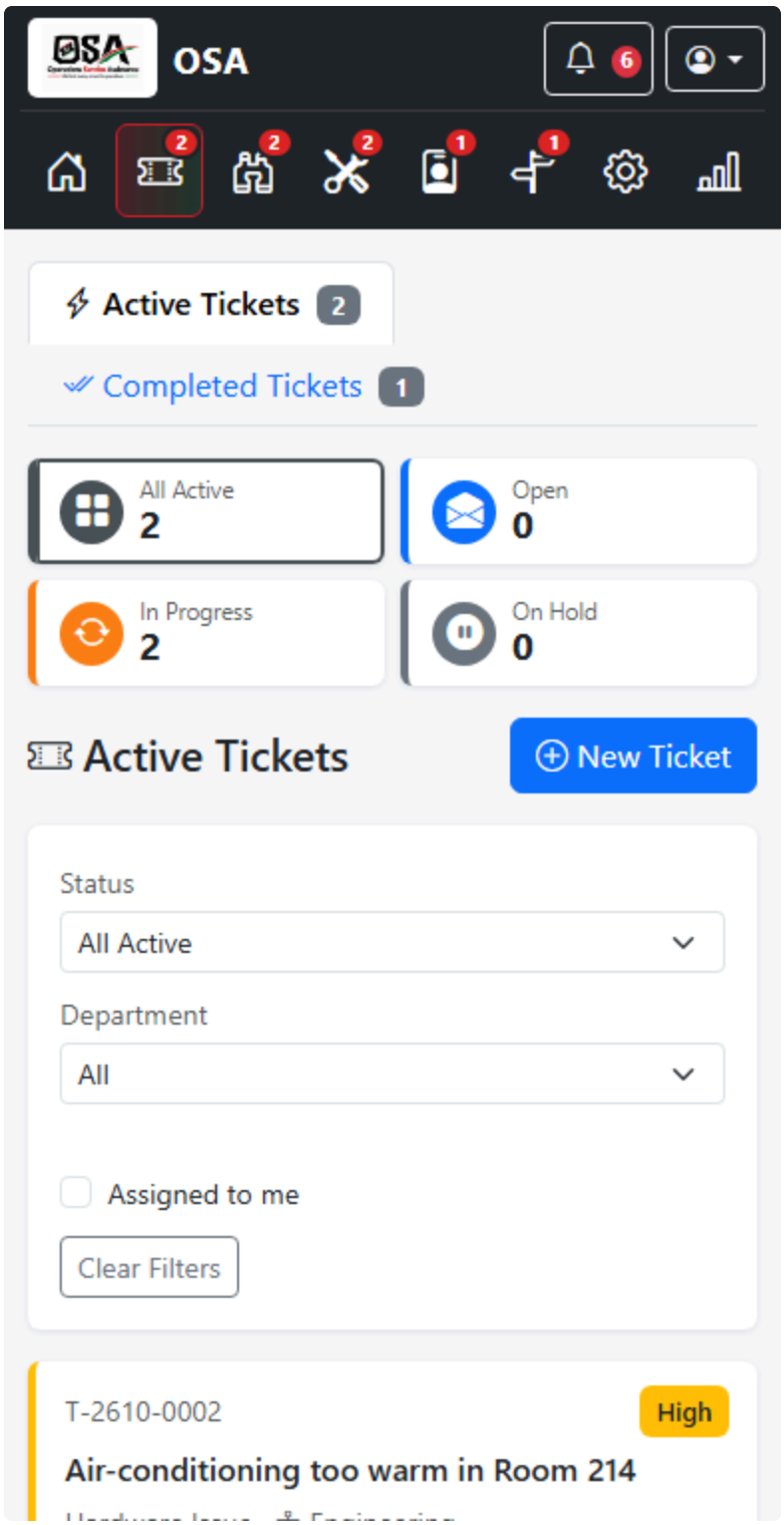
The bar along the top is on every page:

- **Icons on the left** take you to each area. Hold your mouse over an icon to see its name.
- **The date** is shown on the right. Click it to open a calendar.
- **The bell** shows news about your tickets and requests waiting for you (see section 9).
- **Your name** opens the menu with Change Password and Sign Out.
- **The OSA logo** always takes you back to Home.

A small **red number** on a tab icon shows how many things need your attention in that area: new ticket news on Tickets and Lost & Found, tasks that are overdue or due this week on Maintenance, and requests waiting for you on Access Requests and Workflow Requests. Open the tab to deal with them.

Using OSA on a phone

OSA works in your phone's browser. Open the same address you use on your PC and sign in. On a small screen the tab icons sit in a row under the logo, the ticket list shows one card per ticket, and the Admin menu folds into a single button that you tap to open.



On a phone: each ticket is a card with its priority, status and who it is assigned to. Tap a card to open the ticket.

2. Report a problem (create a ticket)

Create a ticket for every problem you want IT to fix. It takes about a minute, and the more detail you give, the faster it is solved.

1. Click **Tickets** (ticket icon), then the blue **New Ticket** button.
2. Fill in the form (fields marked with a red star are required).
3. Click **Submit Ticket**.

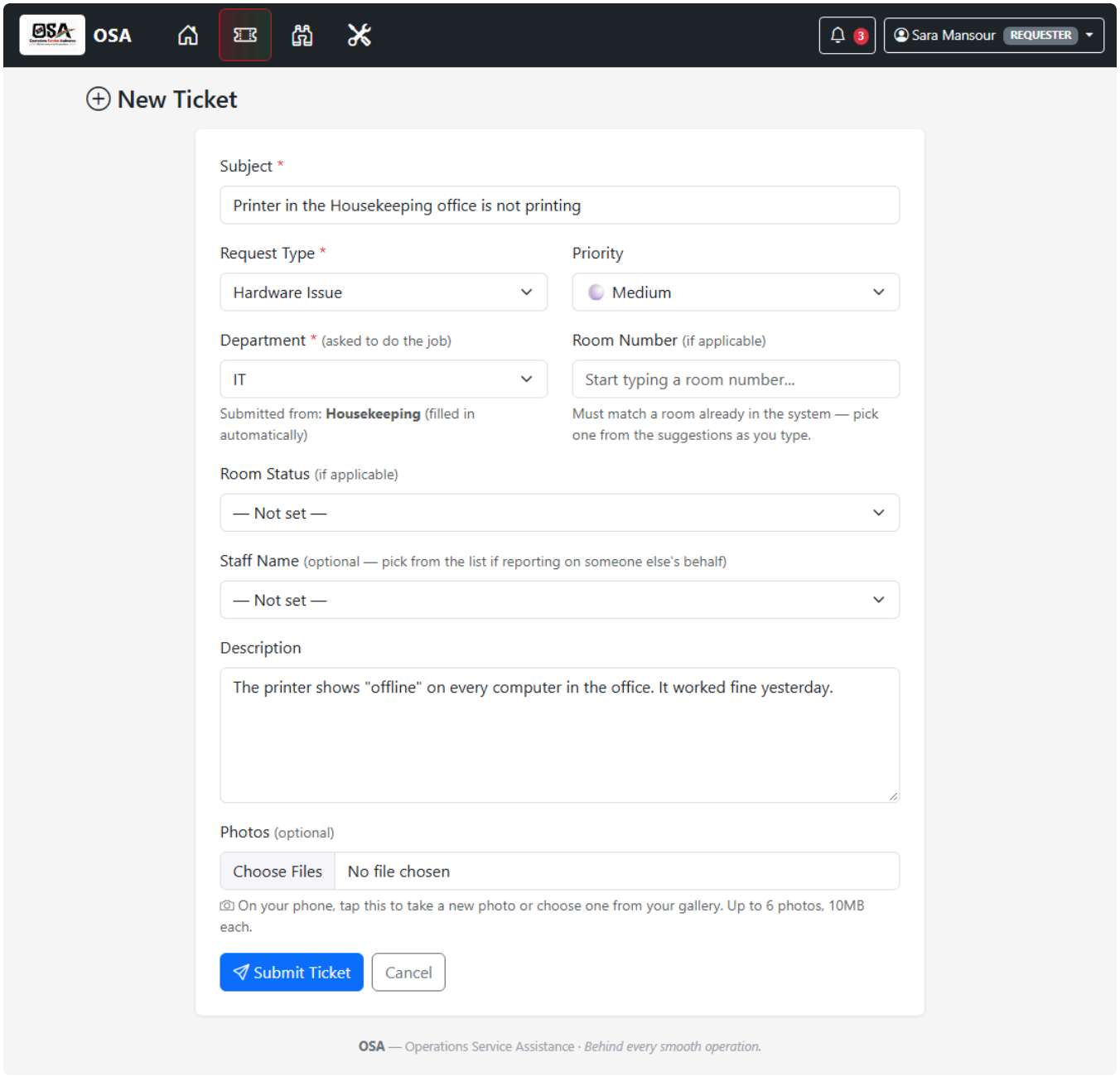


Figure 3: The New Ticket form, filled in as an example.

Field	What to enter
Subject *	A short title, e.g. "Printer not working at Front Desk"
Request Type *	Pick the closest match (Hardware, Software, Network / Wi-Fi, POS / PMS and so on)
Priority	How urgent it is. Leave it on Medium unless guests or sales are affected
Department *	The department you want to do the job, for example IT or Engineering. Choosing the request type suggests one
Room Number	Only for a room problem. Start typing and pick a room from the list
Room Status	Vacant, or Occupied with the guest in or out
Staff Name	Only if you are reporting for someone else. Pick the person from the list (it shows staff from your own department)
Description	What is wrong, when it started, and what you already tried
Photos	Optional. Up to 6 photos. On a phone you can take one straight away

When it is saved you get a **ticket number** such as T-2610-0001. Quote it if you phone IT.

Your own department is recorded automatically as **Submitted from**. You can see it under the Department box, and you cannot change it. This is how reports and notifications know which department asked and which department was asked.

Choosing a priority:

- **Urgent:** a guest or the whole hotel is affected (no check-in possible, POS down).
- **High:** an important task is blocked, but there is a workaround.
- **Medium:** normal faults. This is the default.
- **Low:** small things that can wait, or requests for new equipment.

3. Follow your tickets

The **Tickets** page shows your tickets in two tabs: **Active Tickets** (still being worked on) and **Completed Tickets** (fixed or closed). The small tiles at the top count tickets by status, and clicking a tile filters the list.

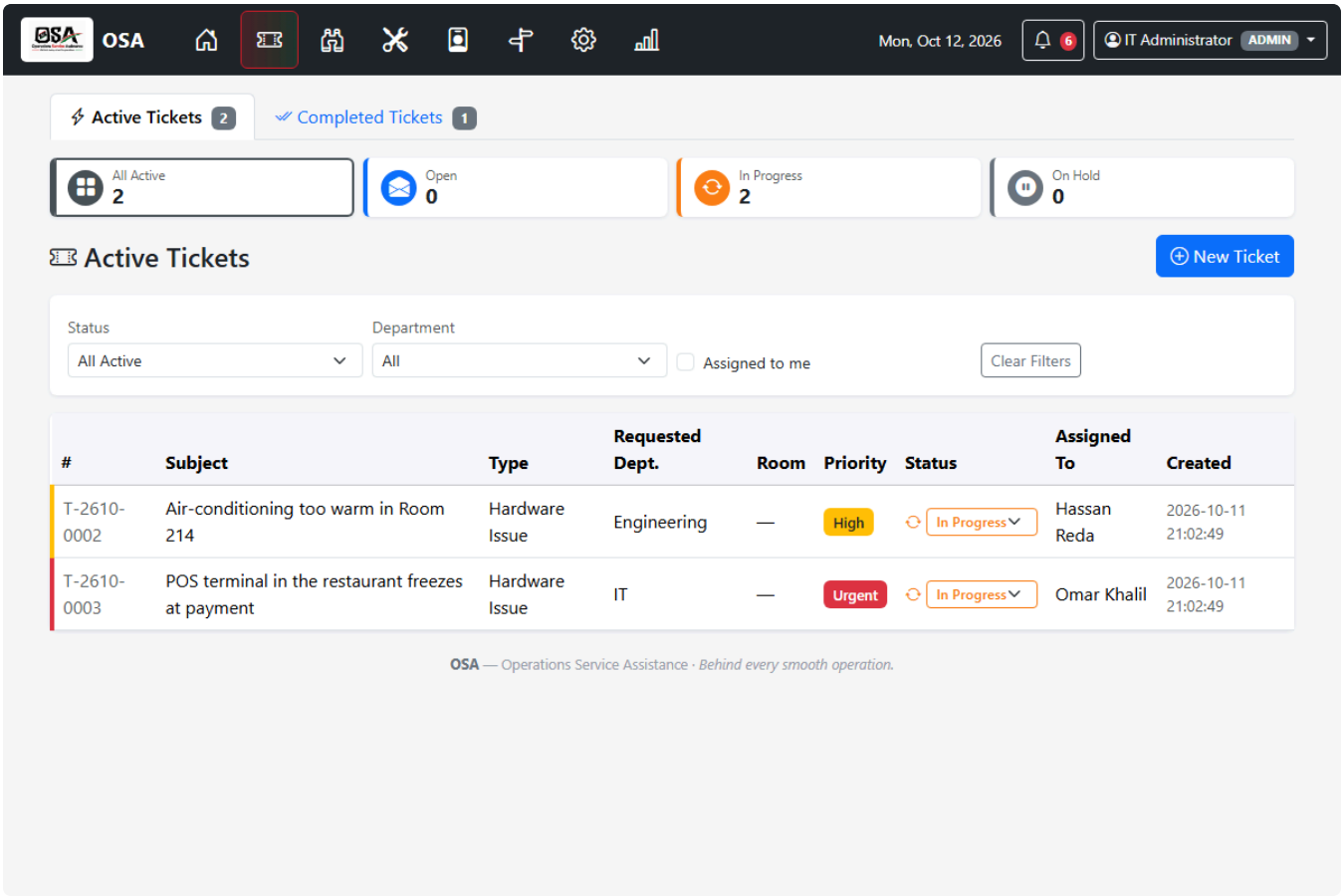


Figure 4: The Tickets list. Each row has a priority colour on the left edge and a status.

Click any row to open the ticket. There you can:

- Read the full details and the history of what IT has done.
- See every photo together in the All Photos section.
- Add a comment (and photos) to give more information or answer a question from IT.
- Use **Prev** and **Next** (buttons at the top of the ticket) to move to the neighbouring tickets without going back to the list.

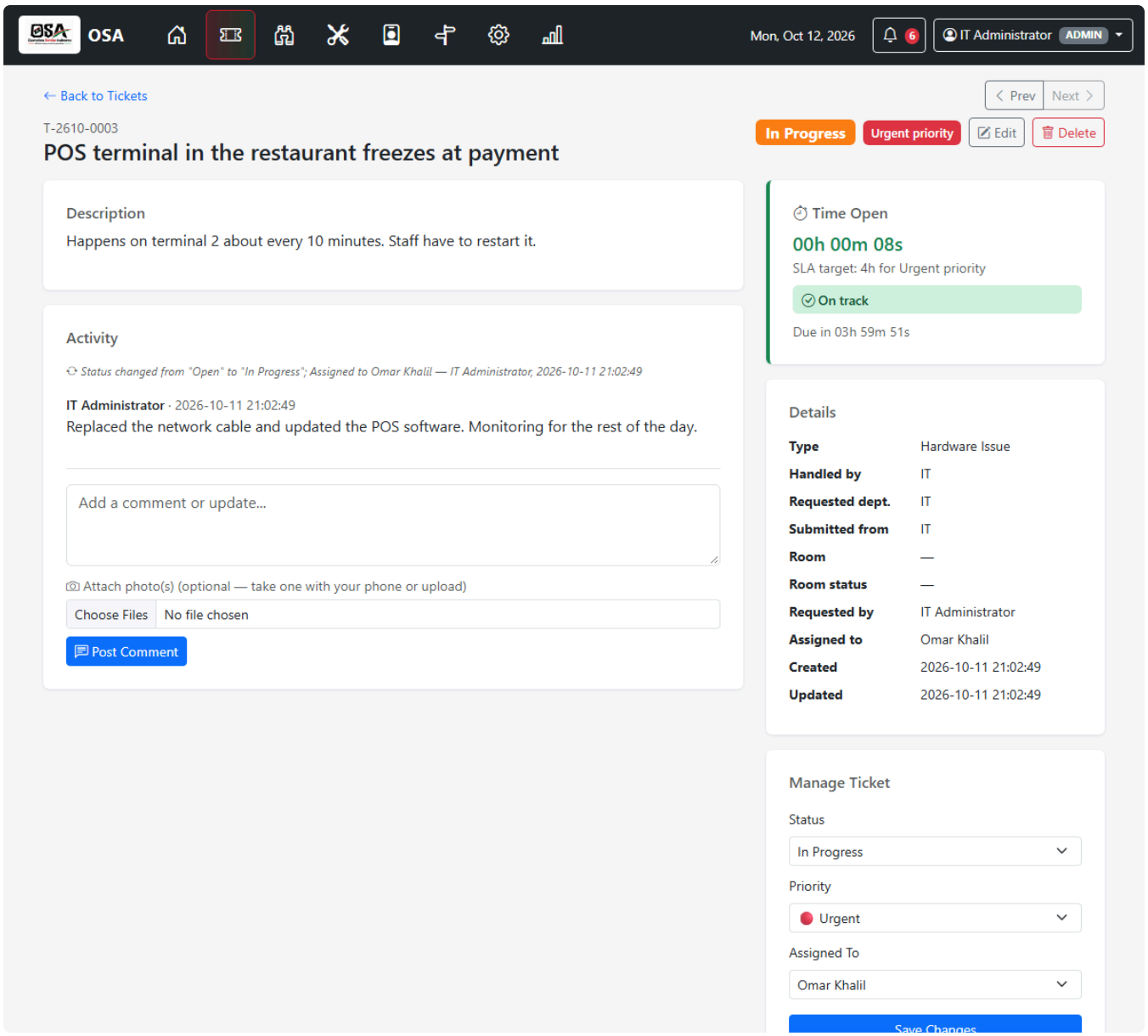


Figure 5: An open ticket. IT staff also see the Manage Ticket box at the bottom right.

Please add a comment to your existing ticket instead of creating a second ticket for the same problem.

Who can see a ticket

You always see the tickets you submitted. If your administrator has given you the permission *See department tickets*, you also see tickets raised by your department and tickets sent to your department, and you can add comments to them. You cannot change their status. Administrators see every ticket.

When a ticket you can see is created or updated by someone else, it appears in your bell (see section 9).

What the statuses mean

Status	Meaning
Open	IT has received your ticket and has not started yet
In Progress	Someone is working on it now
On Hold	Waiting for a part, a supplier, or information from you
Resolved	IT believes it is fixed. Tell them if it is not
Closed	Finished. Nothing more to do

What the colours mean

Each row has a coloured stripe on its left edge, matching its priority: red for Urgent, yellow for High, grey for Medium and green for Low. A paperclip means the ticket has photos.

The ticket also has a timer. It turns **yellow** when most of the target time has passed and **red** when the target time has passed without a fix. You do not need to do anything about it, and IT watches it closely.

4. IT staff: working on tickets

If you handle tickets, your job is to keep the status honest so everyone can see where each problem stands. Every change you make is recorded automatically in the ticket's history.

When a new ticket arrives

A pop-up appears at the bottom right of the screen for tickets sent to your department. Click it to open the ticket, or click the **X** to dismiss it. Pop-ups come back only for new tickets.

Changing the status quickly

On the Tickets list, the Status column has a small drop-down for each ticket. Choose a new status and it saves straight away, with no extra button.

Working a ticket in detail

1. Open the ticket and find the **Manage Ticket** box on the right.

2. Set the **Status**, **Priority**, who it is **Assigned To**, and (for room problems) the **Room Status**.
3. Click **Save Changes**.
4. Write what you did in the comment box and click Post Comment. Add photos if they help.

The **Assigned To** box lists the staff members your administrator has added, grouped by department, with the department the ticket was requested of shown first. Choosing a person here is what lets Reports show how many tickets each person handled.

A good routine

- Move a ticket to **In Progress** as soon as you start, so the requester knows.
- Use **On Hold** when you are waiting for someone or something, and say what in a comment.
- Use **Resolved** when it is fixed, with a short note of what you did. Use **Closed** once it is confirmed.
- Use the **Assigned to me** filter on the list to see your own work.
- Keep an eye on the red banner at the top of the list: it counts tickets that are past their target time.

Editing a ticket and deleting a ticket are two separate permissions, so an administrator can give each one only to the people who need it. Deleting always asks for a reason, which is recorded.

5. Lost & Found

Log every item a guest leaves behind, so any colleague can answer a guest who calls to ask for it. Each item gets its own serial number, such as L-2610-0001.

Report a found item

1. Click **Lost & Found** (binoculars icon), then **Report Found Item**.
2. Describe the item (required), for example "Black leather wallet".
3. Enter where it was found: a room number or area such as the pool or lobby.
4. Check **Found By** (it starts as your name) and the **Date & Time Found**.
5. Add notes and, if you can, a photo.
6. Click **Save Item**.

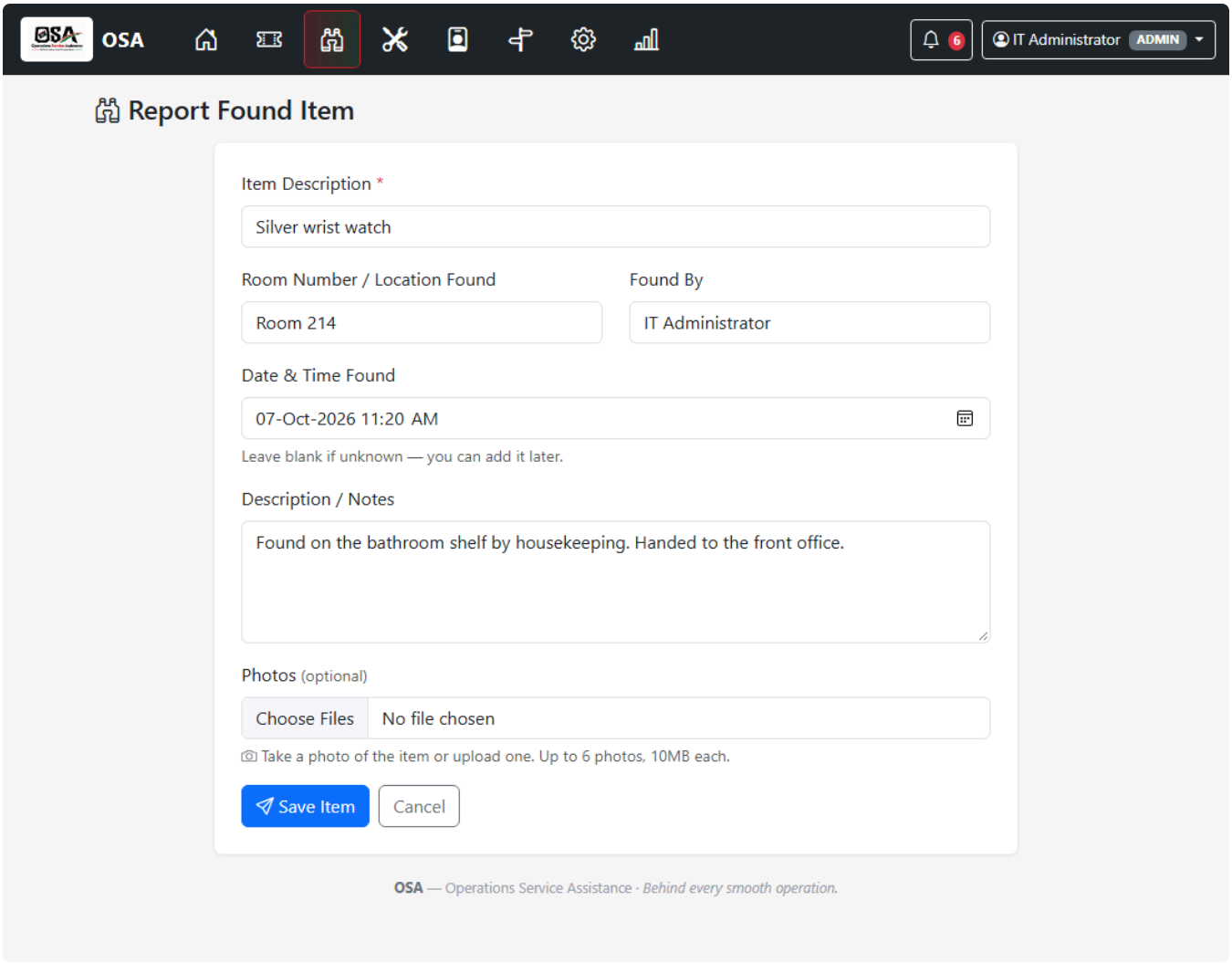


Figure 6: Reporting a found item.

Keep the record up to date

Open an item to see its history and how long it has been in storage. Whoever handles lost property uses the **Manage Item** box to:

- Set the **Status**: In Storage, Returned to Guest, or Disposed.
- Tick **Guest has been contacted** and write down how and when, in the Guest Contact Notes.
- Click **Save Changes**.

Everyone can add updates with **Post Update**, for example "Handed to housekeeping manager". Never delete notes; add a new one instead.

6. Preventive Maintenance

This area lists the regular checks that keep equipment healthy, such as air-conditioning units, pumps and lifts, so problems are caught before a guest notices. Everyone can view it. Only people with permission can add tasks or mark them done.

At the top, the tiles show **All Tasks**, **Overdue** (red, past their due date) and **Due Soon** (orange, due within 7 days). In the list, overdue tasks are shaded red and tasks due soon are shaded yellow.

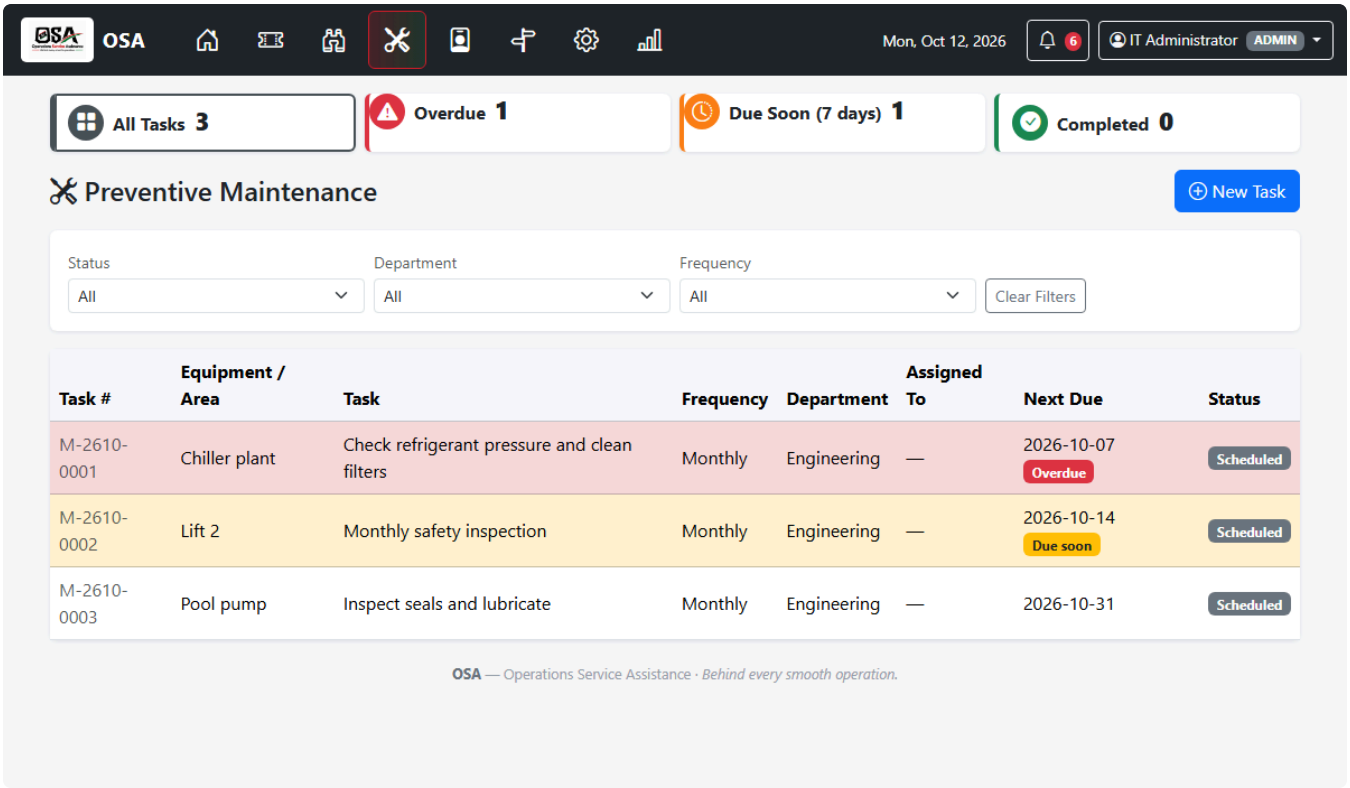


Figure 7: The Preventive Maintenance list. Red rows are overdue, yellow rows are due soon.

Add a task (if you have permission)

1. Click **Maintenance** (tools icon), then **New Task**.
2. Enter the **Equipment / Area** and what must be done.
3. Choose how often it repeats (daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, every six months or yearly) and the **Next Due Date**.
4. Optionally choose the department and who it is assigned to, then click **Create Task**.

Mark a task done

Open the task, add a short note if you like (for example "Filter replaced"), and click **Mark Complete**. OSA works out the next due date by itself from the repeat setting, so you never have to recreate the task. The note is saved in the task's history.

7. IT Access Requests for new joiners (HR, Managers, IT)

When someone joins the hotel, HR asks IT for their accounts and equipment here. The request is approved step by step and every action is recorded, so nothing is missed or done without permission. You only see this area if your role is part of the process.

Who	What they do
HR	Enters the employee's details and hardware needs, then submits
Head of Department	Chooses which systems and access levels the new person needs, then approves or rejects
HR Manager	Approves or rejects
IT Manager	Approves or rejects
General Manager	Approves only when the request includes VPN / Remote Access, the Finance system, or admin-level access (such as OPERA Supervisor or POS Manager)
IT team	Creates the accounts, issues the equipment and completes the checklist

HR: create a request

1. Click **Access Requests**, then **New Request**.
2. Enter the full name as in the passport, job title, department, reporting manager, mobile number, employment type and **start date**. Temporary and Intern staff also need a contract end date.
3. A yellow warning appears if the start date is less than 3 working days away. IT may not have enough time, so send requests early.
4. Tick the hardware needed (laptop or desktop, phone extension, radio, printer, peripherals).
5. Click **Submit Request**, or **Save as Draft** to finish later.

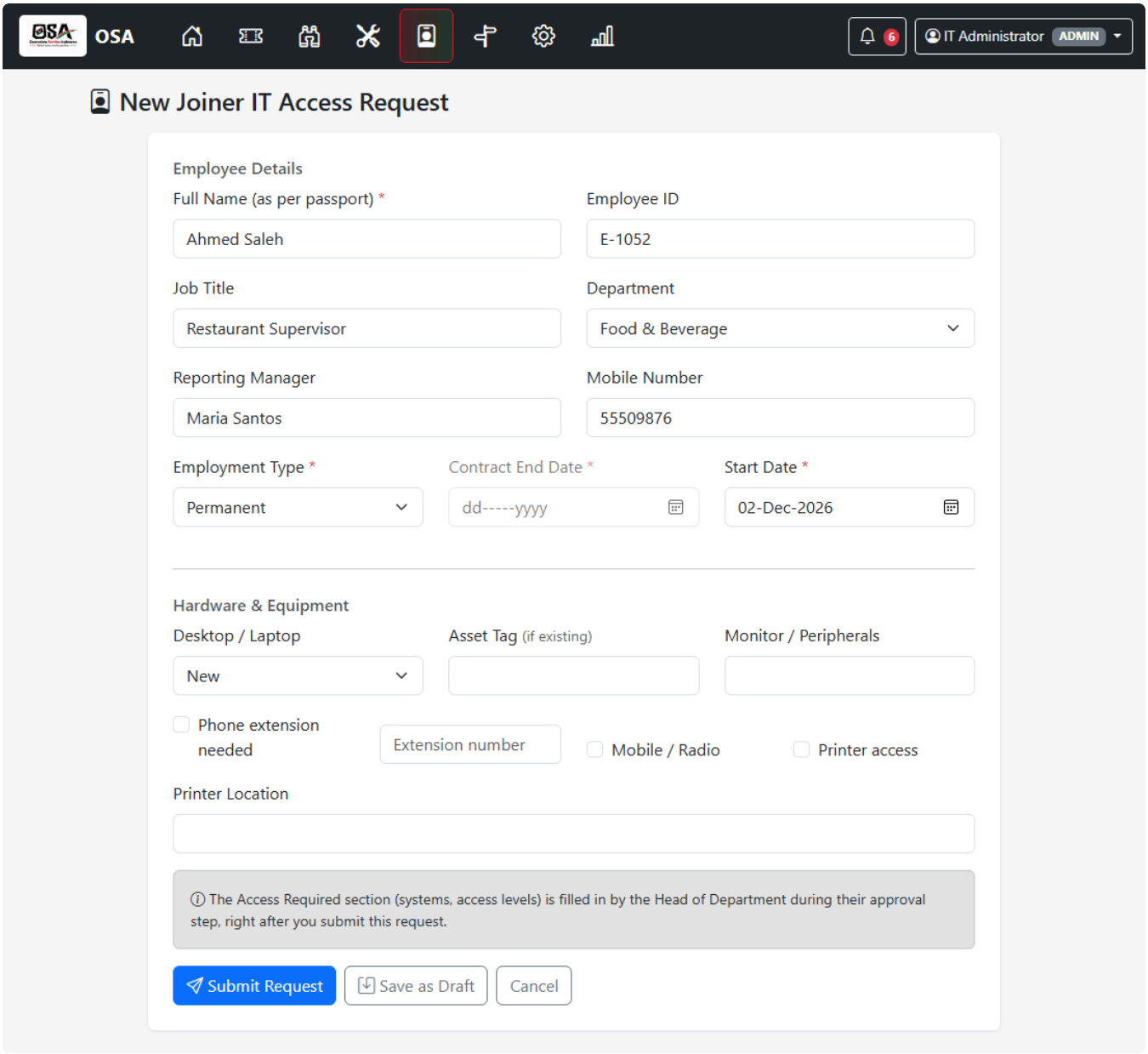


Figure 8: The New Joiner IT Access Request form (HR fills in this part).

The request gets a reference number such as ITR-2026-0001 and moves through these steps: Pending HOD, Pending HR, Pending IT Manager, Pending GM (only if needed), Approved, In Progress, Awaiting User Acknowledgment, Closed.

Approvers

Open the request from the bell or the Access Requests list, read it, add a comment, then click **Approve** or **Reject**. If you reject, always write the reason: it is shown on the request. The Head of Department also ticks the systems and access levels in the table on that page before approving.

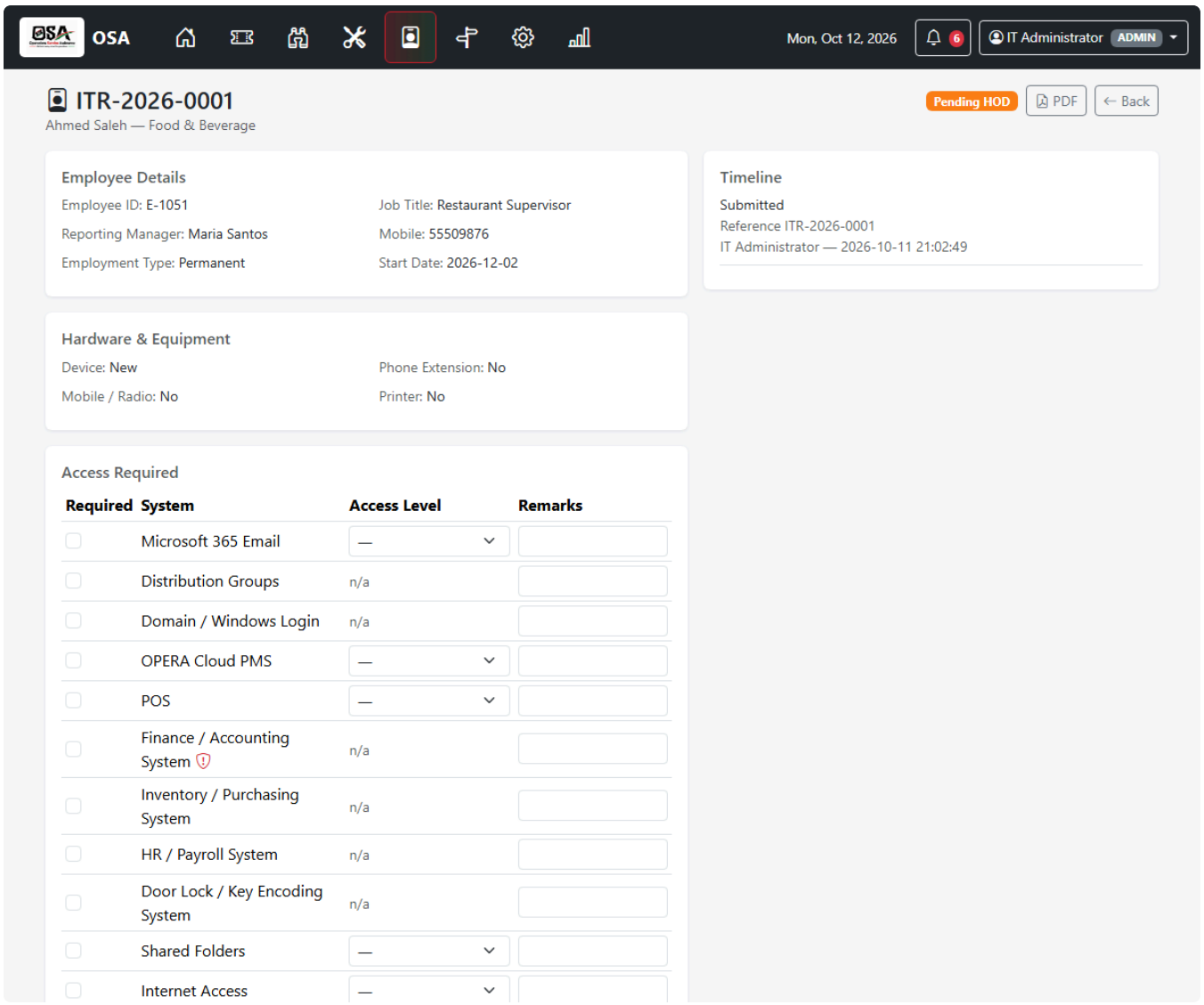


Figure 9: A request waiting for the Head of Department, who ticks the systems needed and clicks Approve or Reject.

IT: finish the job

1. When the status is Approved, click **Start Fulfilment**.
2. Fill in the **IT Completion Checklist**: usernames created, equipment issued, asset register updated, credentials handed over securely, user briefed. Click **Mark Complete**.
3. When the new employee confirms they received their accounts and equipment and accept the IT Acceptable Use and Data Security policies, click **Record Acknowledgment & Close**.

Use the **PDF** button on any request for a printable copy. The submitter can cancel an open request with the **Cancel Request** button.

Never type a password into a request. OSA does not store passwords, and they must be given to the employee in person.

8. Workflow Requests (HR, Heads of Department, Finance, IT)

Use Workflow Requests when something needs IT's help **and** needs approval first, for example a new laptop for a department or software that costs money. The request travels through the right people in order, and everyone can see where it is. You only see this area if your role is part of the process.

Who	What they do
HR	Creates the request and submits it
Head of Department	Adds their input and any cost, then approves or returns it
Finance	Approves the cost. Only used when there is a cost
IT team	Does the work and marks it complete

The request moves through these steps: **HR, Head of Department, Finance (only if there is a cost), IT**. If the Head of Department says there is no cost, it skips Finance and goes straight to IT.

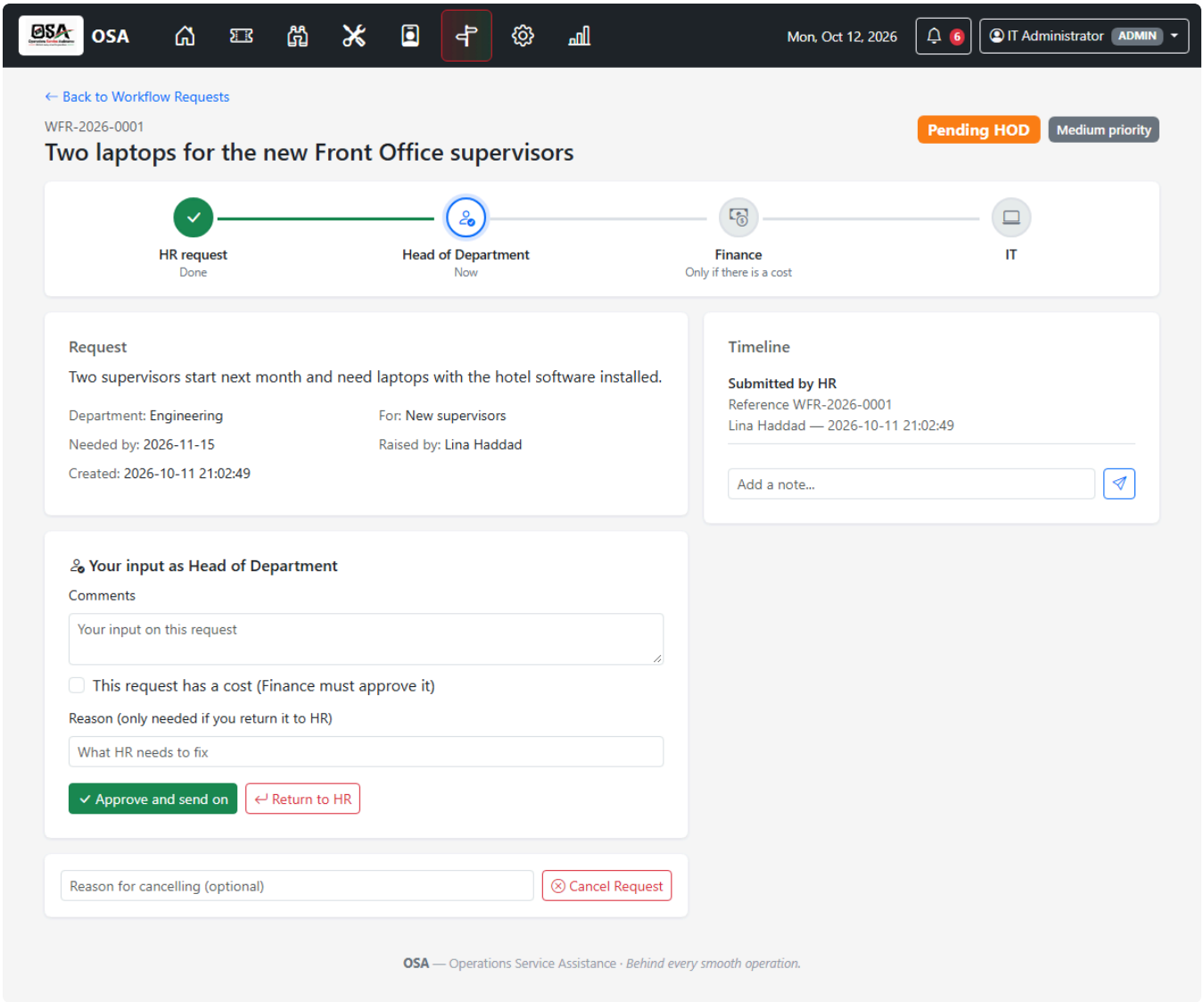


Figure 10: A workflow request. The bar at the top shows where it is: HR, Head of Department, Finance (only if there is a cost), then IT.

HR: create a request

1. Click **Workflow Requests** (the signpost icon), then **New Request**.
2. Enter a short **Title**, describe what is needed and why, choose the **Department**, and say who it is for.
3. Choose the **Priority** and, if you know it, the date it is **Needed by**. Add photos if they help.
4. Click **Submit Request**, or **Save as Draft** to finish later. Only you can see a draft.

The request gets a reference number such as WFR-2026-0001. It keeps the same number for its whole life, even if it is returned and sent again.

Head of Department: add your input

1. Open the request from the bell or the list. You only see requests for your own department.
2. Write your comments. If the request costs money, tick **This request has a cost**, then enter the amount and what it is for.
3. Click **Approve and send on**. If something is missing, type the reason and click **Return to HR** instead.

Finance: approve the cost

Open the request, check the amount, add a comment and click **Approve cost**. If the cost cannot be approved, write the reason and click **Return to HR**.

IT: do the work

1. When the request reaches you it shows **Pending IT**. Click **Start Work** to take it on.
2. When it is done, write what you did in the box and click **Mark Completed**. A note is required, because HR and the managers read it.

If a request is returned to HR

HR sees a yellow box with the reason. Click **Fix and resubmit**, correct the request and click **Resubmit**. It keeps the same reference number.

Every step is written in the **Timeline** on the right of the request, with who did it and when. Anyone involved can add a note there. HR can **Cancel Request** while it is still open.

The bell and the pop-ups tell you when a workflow request is waiting for you (see section 9).

9. Notifications and your account

OSA tells you when something needs your attention, in two ways.

- **The bell** (top right) has a red number when IT access requests or workflow requests are waiting for you or still open from your side. Click the bell to see the list, then click one to open it.
- **Pop-ups** appear at the bottom right for a few seconds, for example "New ticket for your department" or "Access request awaiting you". Click a pop-up to open the item, or click the **X** to close it.

Pop-ups only appear for things that happen **while you are signed in**. Whatever was already waiting when you signed in is shown as the red numbers on the tabs and in the bell, so you are not flooded with pop-ups at the start of the day.

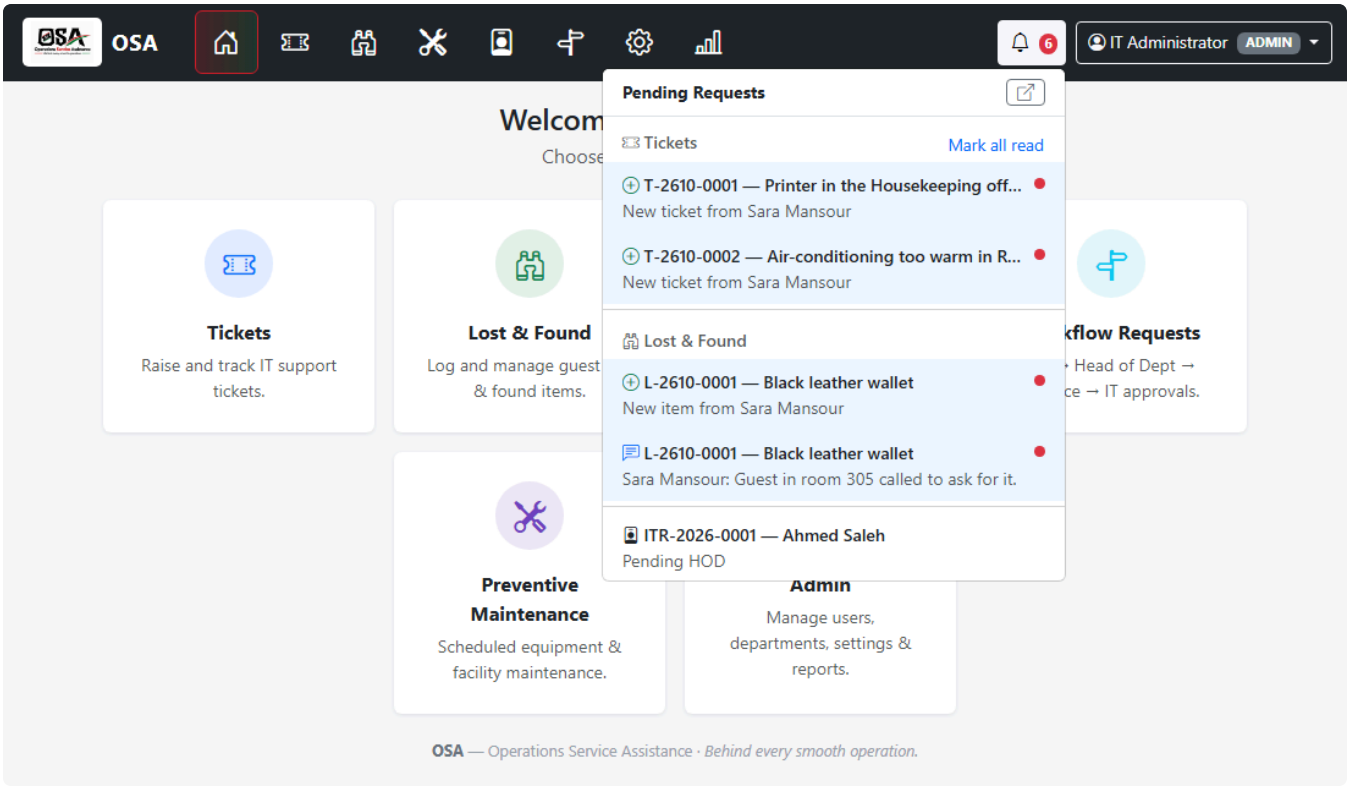


Figure 11: The bell menu lists requests that need your attention.

All notifications in one page

The bell lists the latest news, grouped by area: your **Tickets** and **Lost & Found** news first (unread items are tinted with a red dot), then access requests and workflow requests waiting for you. You hear about new tickets and about updates on tickets that concern you or your department. You never get notified about your own actions.

Click the small button next to **Pending Requests**, or **View all notifications** at the bottom, to open the Notifications page. It shows everything grouped by area: Tickets, Lost & Found, IT Access Requests, Workflow Requests and Maintenance (tasks that are overdue or due this week). Each notification is a card with a coloured icon (green for something new, dark for an update, orange for something waiting for you, red for overdue). Click the X on a card to hide it on your computer, and Show dismissed to bring hidden cards back. Click a group name at the top to see only that area, and **Mark all as read** to clear the unread marks.

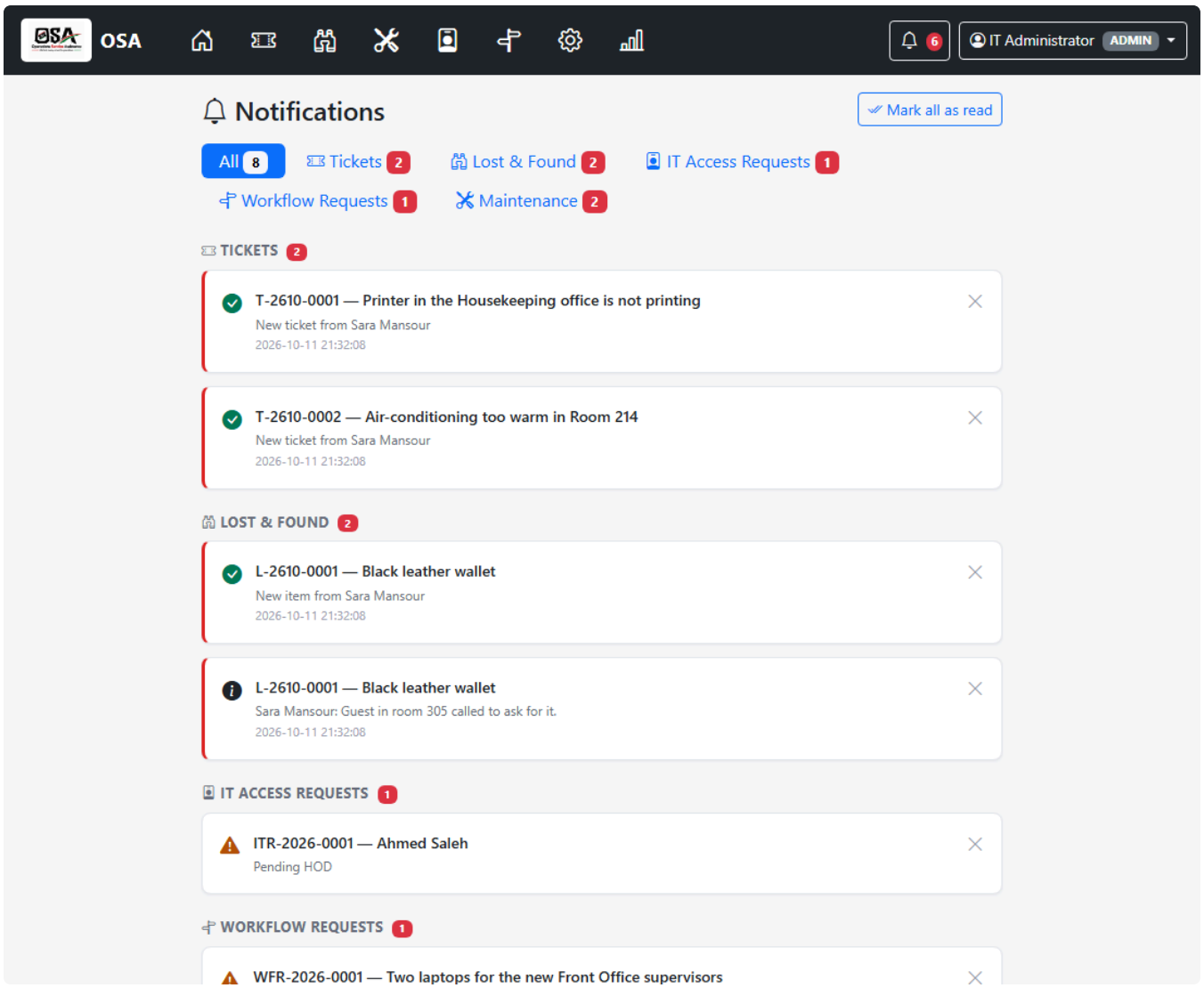


Figure 12: The Notifications page lists everything in one place, grouped by area.

If a pop-up says **License Expiring Soon** after you sign in, just click Dismiss and let your administrator know. Nothing is wrong yet.

Your password

1. Click your name (top right), then **Change Password**.
2. Type your current password, then the new one twice, and save. Use at least 6 characters; longer is safer.
3. Do not share your password or write it where others can see it.

You are signed out automatically after 12 hours. On a shared computer, always click your name and **Sign Out** when you leave.

10. Quick reference and good habits

Numbers you will see

Starts with	What it is	Example
T-	A ticket	T-2610-0001
L-	A lost & found item	L-2610-0001
M-	A maintenance task	M-2610-0001
ITR-	An IT access request	ITR-2026-0001
WFR-	A workflow request	WFR-2026-0001

In T-, L- and M- numbers, the four digits after the letter are the year and month (2610 means October 2026), followed by a running number.

Priority colours (your administrator can add more levels, each with its own colour)

Priority	Colour
Urgent	Red
High	Yellow
Medium	Grey
Low	Green

Do

- Create one ticket per problem, with a clear subject.
- Include the room number or location and a photo when you can.
- Add comments to your existing ticket when you have news.
- Check the **Completed Tickets** tab before reporting again.
- Sign out on shared computers.

Please don't

- Share your password or sign in as someone else.
- Create duplicate tickets to speed things up. It slows everyone down.

- Type passwords or card numbers into tickets, comments or notes.
- Set every ticket to Urgent. Keep Urgent for real emergencies.

11. Managers: reports and staff performance

The **Reports** page (chart icon) shows how the hotel's tickets are going. You need the permission *See reports*. Unless you also have *See every department*, the page only includes tickets that belong to your own department: tickets requested of it, raised from it, or sent to it. A blue note at the top tells you when the page is limited like this.

- **Top tiles and charts:** total and open tickets, average time to resolve, how often the target time was met, and tickets opened against finished each day.
- **Detailed Breakdown:** tickets by status, priority, department, request type and assigned staff.
- **Tickets Handled by Staff:** each person's name, department and how many tickets they handled, with how many are finished. Click a name to open that person's tickets.
- **Staff Performance:** one table per department showing, for each person, tickets assigned, completed, still open, the average time to finish and the share finished within the target time.

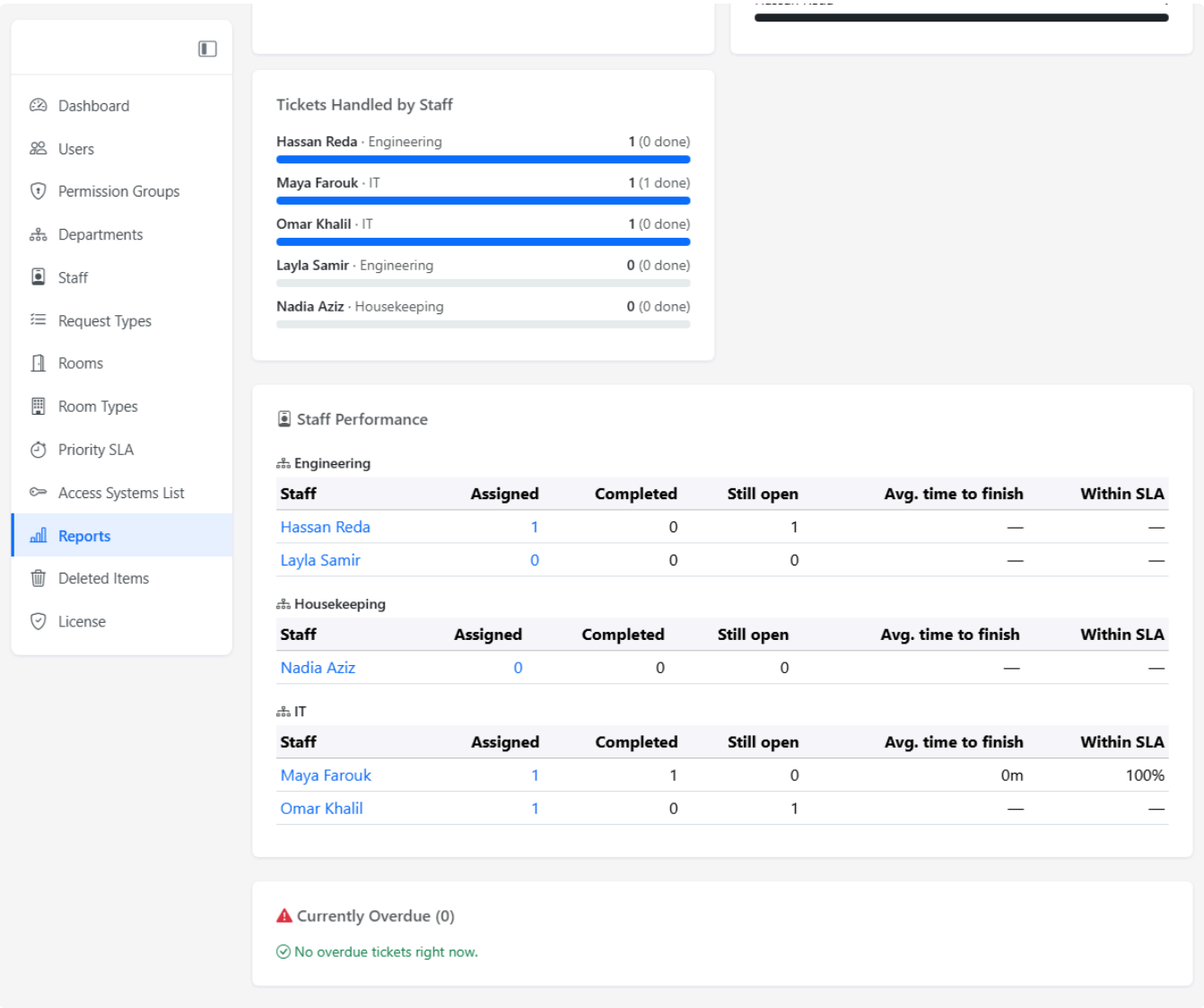


Figure 13: Tickets Handled by Staff and the Staff Performance table, grouped by department.

A person only appears with numbers once tickets have been assigned to them in the **Assigned To** box on the ticket, so ask IT staff to always choose a name there.

12. Administrators: staff list and permission groups

Staff list

Open **Admin**, then **Staff**. Add each person who handles tickets with their name and department. If they also have a sign-in, link it so the *Assigned to me* filter works for them. Tick or untick **Active** when someone joins or leaves: people who left disappear from the choices but their old tickets stay in the reports.

To add many people at once, click **Download the template**, fill it in with Excel (one person per row, department spelled as in Admin, then Departments), save it as **CSV** and upload it in the **Add Many at Once** box. If any row has a problem nothing is added, and the page tells you exactly which rows to fix.

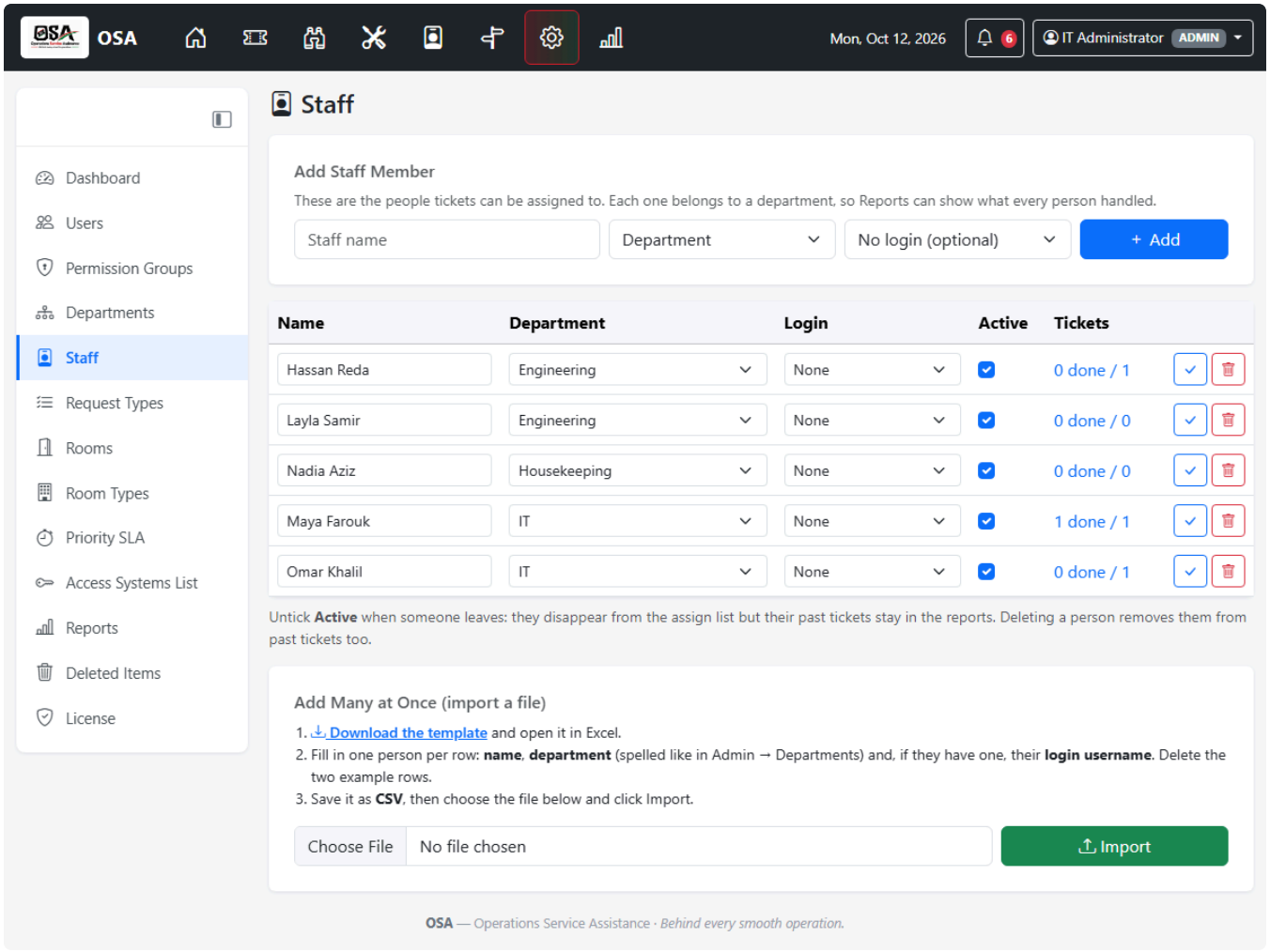


Figure 14: The Staff page.

Permission groups

A group is a set of things its members may do. Open **Admin**, then **Permission Groups**, click **New Group**, tick what the members need and save. Then open **Admin**, then **Users** and choose the group for each person. Permissions are arranged by area (Tickets, Lost & Found, Maintenance, IT Access Requests, Workflow Requests, Reports, Administration), and each area has **All** and **None** links.

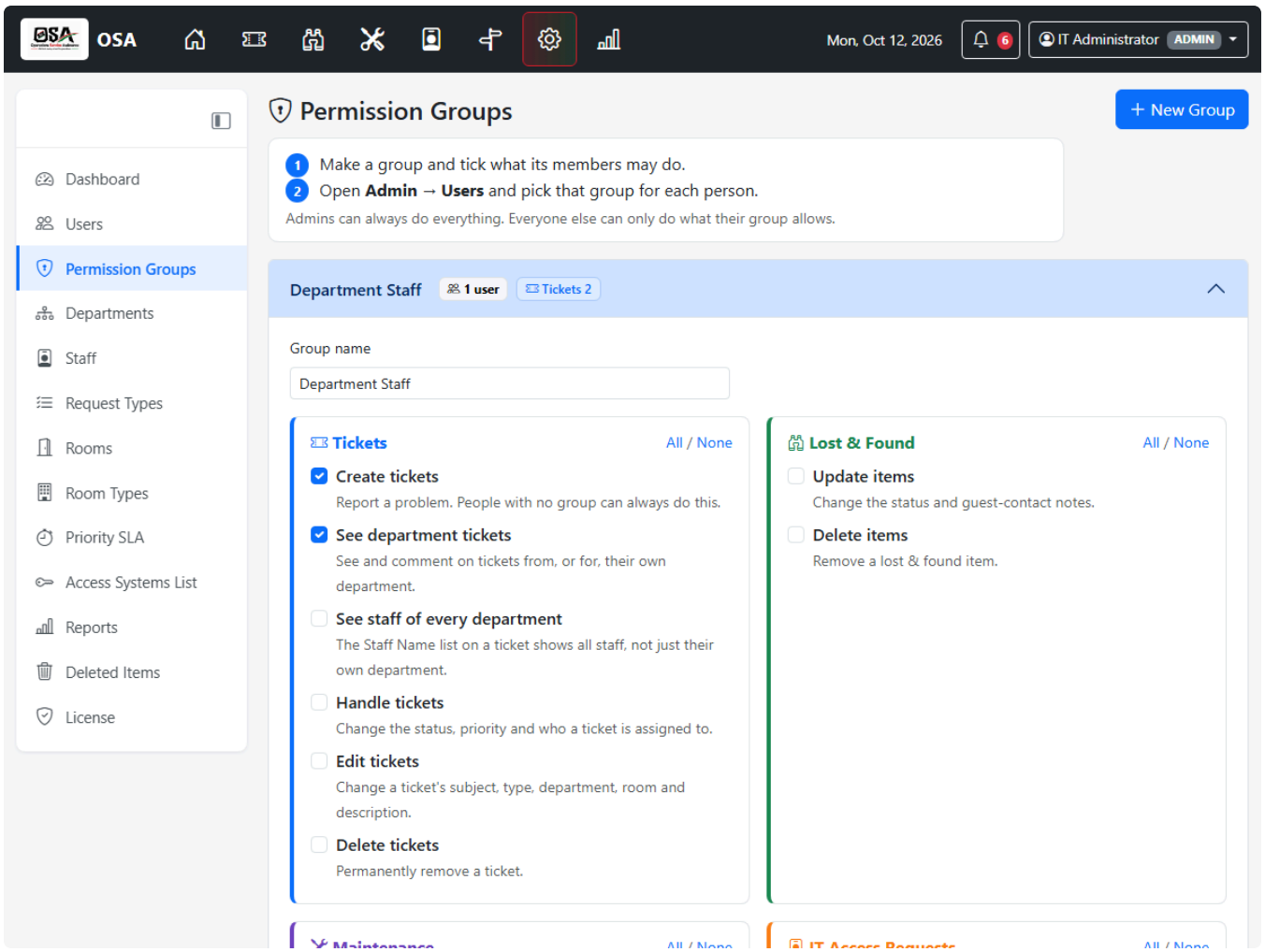


Figure 15: A permission group. Each area has its own boxes with a short explanation.

A few things worth knowing:

- Editing and deleting are separate boxes for tickets and for maintenance tasks, so you can allow one without the other.
- *See department tickets* lets someone see and comment on tickets of their own department. *See staff of every department* widens the Staff Name list on the ticket form. *See every department* (under Reports) widens the Reports page.
- The **Admin** tab only appears for people who have an administration permission (manage settings, manage users or the systems list). Someone who only has *See reports* gets the Reports tab, not Admin.

Starting OSA on a PC (OSA.exe)

OSA comes as a single file, `OSA.exe`, in a zip named *OSA-Ticketing-System-V2* with the date. Nothing has to be installed.

1. Copy the folder to the PC that will run OSA (for example `C:\OSA`).

2. Double-click `OSA.exe`. A black window opens and the browser goes to OSA. Keep that window open while people use OSA, and close it to stop the system.
3. The first time, Windows asks about network access. Choose **Allow** so other PCs and phones can connect.
4. The black window shows an address like `http://192.168.1.50:3000`. Other people open that address in their browser.
5. Sign in as **admin** (password *ChangeMe123!*), change the password, then open **Admin**, then **License** and upload your license file.

OSA keeps its information in two folders next to `OSA.exe`: **data** (the database) and **uploads** (photos). Back both up regularly. To move OSA to another PC, copy `OSA.exe` together with these two folders. To update OSA, replace `OSA.exe` only and keep the two folders.

13. Who to ask for help

If something in OSA does not work or you are not sure what to do, ask in this order: read the relevant section of this guide, ask a colleague in your team, then contact IT.

Need	Contact
Cannot sign in or forgot your password	IT Helpdesk: [phone / extension to be filled in]
Something in OSA looks wrong	IT Administrator: [name and contact to be filled in]
Need a new account or different permissions	Your Head of Department, who asks IT
Urgent problem when OSA itself is not available	Call IT directly on [number to be filled in]

The square brackets above are placeholders. Replace them with your hotel's real contact details before sharing this guide.